

GRE-Style Verbal Reasoning Practice Set

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This reader copy places all answer keys and explanations after the questions so you can work through the set before checking solutions.

Contents: 15 Reading Comprehension questions, 9 Text Completion questions, and 6 Sentence Equivalence questions.

Questions

Reading Comprehension

Passage 1

Museum conservators have increasingly used multispectral imaging to study old paintings without removing varnish or sampling pigment. The technique can reveal underdrawings and later revisions, but its results are not self-interpreting. A dark shape beneath a painted surface may indicate an abandoned compositional plan, a repair, or even a stain in a preparatory layer. For this reason, some conservators argue that imaging should be treated less as a decisive diagnostic tool than as a source of hypotheses to be checked against archival records, material analysis, and knowledge of an artist's workshop practices. The most persuasive attributions, in their view, emerge when technical evidence and historical context constrain one another.

rc-001. Which of the following best states the main point of the passage?

- A. Multispectral imaging has made traditional archival research largely unnecessary in conservation work.
- B. Technical imaging is valuable in conservation, but its findings require corroboration from other forms of evidence.
- C. The best way to attribute paintings is to compare their visible style with an artist's authenticated works.
- D. Conservators disagree primarily about whether old varnish should be removed before paintings are studied.
- E. Material analysis is less reliable than imaging because it can damage fragile paintings.

rc-002. The passage suggests that the conservators mentioned would be most skeptical of which of the following claims?

- A. An image beneath the paint surface can sometimes help identify a painter's working method.
- B. A single imaging result can conclusively establish a painting's attribution without further inquiry.
- C. Archival records may help determine whether a painted revision is historically plausible.
- D. A technical finding may prompt researchers to ask new questions about a painting.
- E. Workshop practices can be relevant to interpreting physical evidence in a painting.

rc-003. Based on the passage, which of the following are possible interpretations of a dark shape revealed beneath a painted surface? Select all that apply.

- A. It may be evidence of a composition the artist began but did not complete.

- B. It may result from damage or alteration unrelated to the artist's original design.
- C. It may prove that the visible painting was executed by a different artist.

Passage 2

Urban planners often praise tree-planting campaigns for cooling neighborhoods, but recent monitoring complicates that simple picture. In districts where mature trees shade pavement and buildings throughout the afternoon, average surface temperatures do fall. Yet in narrow streets bordered by tall buildings, dense plantings can reduce air circulation and trap humid air after sunset. The result is that residents may experience less daytime heat but little nighttime relief, a problem for people whose health depends on recovery during cooler hours. Planners therefore increasingly distinguish between adding canopy and designing ventilation corridors. The distinction does not diminish the value of trees; rather, it suggests that vegetation must be placed with attention to street geometry and daily temperature cycles.

rc-004. Which of the following best captures the passage's treatment of urban tree planting?

- A. It rejects tree planting because dense vegetation usually increases heat exposure.
- B. It argues that tree planting is beneficial only in neighborhoods without tall buildings.
- C. It presents tree planting as useful but dependent on local physical conditions.
- D. It maintains that ventilation corridors are less important than maximizing canopy area.
- E. It claims that nighttime heat is caused chiefly by a lack of public health planning.

rc-005. The passage implies that a tree-planting plan would be most vulnerable to criticism if it

- A. gave priority to streets where residents currently have little shade at midday.
- B. used mature species that create afternoon shade on paved surfaces.
- C. treated total canopy coverage as sufficient without considering airflow after sunset.
- D. included measurements of both surface temperature and humidity.
- E. paired vegetation with changes to building materials and pavement color.

rc-006. Select the sentence that most directly states the practical planning conclusion drawn from the evidence in the passage.

- A. Urban planners often praise tree-planting campaigns for cooling neighborhoods, but recent monitoring complicates that simple picture.
- B. In districts where mature trees shade pavement and buildings throughout the afternoon, average surface temperatures do fall.
- C. Yet in narrow streets bordered by tall buildings, dense plantings can reduce air circulation and trap humid air after sunset.
- D. The result is that residents may experience less daytime heat but little nighttime relief, a problem for people whose health depends on recovery during cooler hours.
- E. Planners therefore increasingly distinguish between adding canopy and designing ventilation corridors.
- F. The distinction does not diminish the value of trees; rather, it suggests that vegetation must be placed with attention to street geometry and daily temperature cycles.

Passage 3

A common account of medieval marginal drawings treats them as comic eruptions at the edges of otherwise solemn books. That description is not wrong, but it is incomplete. Marginal images could mock authority, entertain a reader, mark a section for later use, or extend a manuscript's argument by visual analogy. A rabbit hunting a hound, for instance, need not be merely absurd; it might invert a familiar hierarchy and thereby echo a text's interest in worldly instability. Because many manuscripts were collaborative objects, the meaning of a marginal figure may also depend on who added it and when. Treating the margins as decorative leftovers risks missing how actively they could participate in reading.

rc-007. The author of the passage would most likely agree with which of the following statements about medieval marginal drawings?

- A. They should be interpreted as serious theological arguments rather than as humorous images.
- B. Their meaning can be more varied and textually engaged than a purely comic account suggests.
- C. They were usually added by readers long after the manuscript text had ceased to be studied.
- D. Their value lies mainly in showing that medieval artists rejected hierarchy.
- E. They are too ambiguous to support any claim about how manuscripts were read.

rc-008. The example of the rabbit hunting a hound serves primarily to

- A. show that marginal drawings were normally intended to replace written commentary.
- B. illustrate how an apparently comic image could reinforce a manuscript's theme.
- C. demonstrate that animal images were more common than human figures in manuscripts.
- D. identify the earliest known use of visual inversion in manuscript decoration.
- E. suggest that readers preferred images whose meanings were fixed and obvious.

rc-009. According to the passage, which of the following are possible functions of marginal images? Select all that apply.

- A. They could help a reader locate a portion of a manuscript.
- B. They could visually develop an idea present in the manuscript's text.
- C. They could guarantee that all later readers understood a manuscript in the same way.

Passage 4

A nonprofit that delivers meals to older adults recently replaced fixed delivery routes with software that assigns stops each morning. Managers reported that the change shortened average driving time and allowed the same staff to serve more clients. Volunteers, however, noticed that some clients became less willing to mention spoiled food or missed items, because they no longer saw the same driver repeatedly. The old routes had created informal relationships through which small problems were reported before they became formal complaints. The software therefore improved one measurable efficiency while weakening a feedback channel that had rarely appeared in performance reports.

rc-010. Which of the following best describes the passage's central claim?

- A. The software failed because it did not shorten delivery routes enough to reduce staff workload.
- B. Efficiency improvements can obscure losses in informal communication that matter to service quality.
- C. Older adults are generally reluctant to report problems unless nonprofit managers solicit complaints.
- D. Fixed delivery routes are always preferable to software-generated routes in nonprofit programs.
- E. Performance reports are useful only when they exclude informal feedback from clients.

rc-011. Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the volunteers' concern?

- A. The software reduced fuel use by grouping stops that were near one another.
- B. Clients who received visits from a consistent driver were more likely to report minor delivery problems promptly.
- C. Some volunteers preferred using printed maps instead of mobile applications.
- D. The nonprofit planned to add several new clients in neighborhoods it already served.
- E. Managers reviewed delivery times more frequently after the software was introduced.

rc-012. Select the sentence that introduces evidence complicating the managers' favorable assessment of the software.

- A. A nonprofit that delivers meals to older adults recently replaced fixed delivery routes with software that assigns stops each morning.
- B. Managers reported that the change shortened average driving time and allowed the same staff to serve more clients.
- C. Volunteers, however, noticed that some clients became less willing to mention spoiled food or missed items, because they no longer saw the same driver repeatedly.
- D. The old routes had created informal relationships through which small problems were reported before they became formal complaints.
- E. The software therefore improved one measurable efficiency while weakening a feedback channel that had rarely appeared in performance reports.

Passage 5

Ecologists studying restored wetlands often count returning bird species as a sign of success. Species counts are useful, but they can mislead when treated as proof that a wetland's ecological functions have recovered. Some birds visit newly flooded areas because open water makes foraging easy, even when the underlying plant community remains simplified. Other species may nest there only briefly if seasonal water levels fluctuate too sharply. For this reason, several researchers recommend pairing bird surveys with measurements of soil chemistry, vegetation structure, and invertebrate abundance. Their point is not that birds are poor indicators, but that a conspicuous response by mobile animals may precede slower changes in the habitat itself.

rc-013. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. arguing that bird surveys should be abandoned in favor of soil and vegetation measures.
- B. explaining why one visible sign of restoration success should be interpreted with caution.
- C. showing that restored wetlands are usually less stable than natural wetlands.
- D. comparing the nesting habits of wetland birds with those of other mobile animals.
- E. criticizing ecologists for ignoring species counts when evaluating restoration projects.

rc-014. The passage suggests that a restored wetland with many visiting bird species might still be considered incompletely recovered if

- A. its soil, plant, and invertebrate conditions remain unlike those of a functioning wetland.
- B. it attracts species that are difficult for observers to distinguish from one another.
- C. its open water allows some birds to forage more efficiently than they could elsewhere.
- D. bird surveys there are conducted more often than vegetation surveys.
- E. mobile animals respond to habitat changes later than plants and invertebrates do.

rc-015. Which of the following would the researchers mentioned in the passage likely regard as useful additions to bird surveys? Select all that apply.

- A. Assessments of the wetland's plant structure.
- B. Measurements of invertebrate abundance.
- C. Counts of bird species conducted without other habitat data.

Text Completion

tc-001. Although the committee's public statement sounded conciliatory, its private memorandum was markedly [blank_1], dismissing every compromise as naive.

Blank 1

- A. placatory
- B. intransigent
- C. diffident
- D. redundant
- E. methodical

tc-002. The software's interface was so [blank_1] that new users could complete complex tasks without consulting the manual.

Blank 1

- A. intuitive
- B. ornate
- C. volatile
- D. opaque
- E. peripheral

tc-003. The historian's prose is not [blank_1]; even when she contests a rival interpretation, she does so without theatrical denunciation.

Blank 1

- A. polemical
- B. chronological
- C. assiduous
- D. elliptical
- E. judicious

tc-004. The architect's proposal was praised for its (i) [blank_1], but city engineers warned that its technical specifications remained (ii) [blank_2].

Blank 1

- A. ingenuity
- B. redundancy
- C. fragility

Blank 2

- D. impracticable
- E. lavish

F. transparent

tc-005. Because the review board had often approved projects after only cursory discussion, its sudden demand for extensive documentation seemed less a sign of new (i) [blank_1] than of institutional (ii) [blank_2].

Blank 1

- A. scrupulousness
- B. improvisation
- C. candor

Blank 2

- D. continuity
- E. caprice
- F. deference

tc-006. The editor was not trying to (i) [blank_1] the novelist's eccentric style; rather, her notes aimed to make its deliberate oddities more (ii) [blank_2] to readers.

Blank 1

- A. standardize
- B. celebrate
- C. amplify

Blank 2

- D. onerous
- E. discernible
- F. incidental

tc-007. The biographer resists the temptation to make her subject either wholly admirable or wholly contemptible: she (i) [blank_1] his public generosity, documents his private evasions, and refuses to let either body of evidence (ii) [blank_2] the other. The result is a portrait whose moral judgment is (iii) [blank_3] rather than evasive.

Blank 1

- A. acknowledges
- B. fabricates
- C. trivializes

Blank 2

- D. eclipse
- E. corroborate
- F. diversify

Blank 3

- G. nuanced
- H. peremptory
- I. incoherent

tc-008. At first the laboratory's failure to reproduce the celebrated result seemed to (i) [blank_1] the original study. Subsequent audits, however, found that the new experiment had used a contaminated reagent, making the failed replication (ii) [blank_2] as evidence against the earlier finding and leaving the debate largely (iii) [blank_3].

Blank 1

- A. discredit
- B. vindicate
- C. publicize

Blank 2

- D. decisive
- E. irrelevant
- F. redundant

Blank 3

- G. settled
- H. unresolved
- I. anachronistic

tc-009. The essay's opening pages promise a (i) [blank_1] defense of local journalism, but the argument soon becomes oddly (ii) [blank_2]: after listing threats to small newspapers, the author digresses into anecdotes that neither explain those threats nor suggest remedies. What began as advocacy thus ends in (iii) [blank_3].

Blank 1

- A. cogent
- B. perfunctory
- C. hostile

Blank 2

- D. focused
- E. desultory
- F. incisive

Blank 3

- G. diffusion
- H. consensus
- I. exoneration

Sentence Equivalence

se-001. The judge's opinion was unusually [blank_1], avoiding broad pronouncements and deciding only the narrow issue before the court.

- A. sweeping
- B. circumscribed
- C. caustic
- D. limited
- E. ceremonial
- F. expansive

se-002. Because the witness revised her account each time new evidence appeared, the attorney portrayed her testimony as [blank_1].

- A. immutable
- B. malleable
- C. adaptable
- D. meticulous
- E. unassailable
- F. laconic

se-003. The curator expected a modest response to the obscure exhibit, but the opening proved unexpectedly [blank_1], with visitors filling every gallery.

- A. muted
- B. sparsely attended
- C. well attended
- D. tumultuous
- E. popular
- F. understated

se-004. The analyst's forecast was [blank_1], not because it predicted disaster, but because it rested on assumptions the report itself had already undermined.

- A. untenable
- B. dire
- C. indefensible
- D. gloomy
- E. prescient
- F. austere

se-005. Although the philosopher's lectures were demanding, students rarely found them [blank_1], since each difficult claim was followed by a clarifying example.

- A. taxing
- B. opaque
- C. arduous
- D. lucid
- E. inscrutable
- F. methodical

se-006. The startup's founders presented their plan as revolutionary, but investors found it largely [blank_1], a repackaging of services already offered by several competitors.

- A. derivative
- B. novel
- C. imitative
- D. profitable
- E. visionary
- F. precarious

GRE-Style Verbal Reasoning Practice Set - Set 2

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Contents: 15 Reading Comprehension questions, 9 Text Completion questions, and 6 Sentence Equivalence questions.

Questions

Reading Comprehension

Passage 1

Researchers reconstructing ancient monsoon patterns sometimes analyze leaf waxes preserved in lake sediments. The hydrogen isotopes in these waxes can reflect rainfall, but the signal is not a simple rain gauge. Plants growing on different slopes may contribute waxes at different rates, and erosion can deliver older material to the lake during storms. A shift in isotope ratios, therefore, might indicate a change in precipitation, a change in which plants supplied the waxes, or a temporary increase in reworked sediments. Several paleoclimatologists now treat leaf-wax records as most persuasive when they align with independent pollen counts, shoreline evidence, and models of seasonal runoff. In their view, the proxy is valuable precisely because it raises testable questions rather than because it yields an isolated chronology.

rc-001. Which of the following best states the main point of the passage?

- A. Leaf-wax records are unreliable because storms can introduce older sediment into lake deposits.
- B. Leaf-wax isotope data can illuminate past rainfall, but they require corroboration and careful interpretation.
- C. Pollen counts and shoreline evidence are more precise indicators of ancient monsoon patterns than isotope records are.
- D. The chief value of leaf-wax analysis is that it can replace models of seasonal runoff.
- E. Researchers have largely abandoned lake sediments because their signals are too difficult to date.

rc-002. The paleoclimatologists mentioned in the passage would be most likely to challenge which of the following claims?

- A. A change in leaf-wax isotope ratios may suggest a change in ancient precipitation patterns.
- B. Different plant communities can affect the isotope signal preserved in lake sediments.
- C. A leaf-wax record is strongest when it agrees with independent lines of evidence.
- D. A single shift in isotope ratios can by itself establish the timing and cause of a monsoon change.
- E. Runoff models can help researchers evaluate sedimentary evidence from lakes.

rc-003. Based on the passage, which of the following are possible explanations for a shift in leaf-wax isotope ratios? Select all that apply.

- A. The amount or character of precipitation changed.
- B. The plants contributing waxes to the lake changed.

C. Storm-driven erosion temporarily delivered older material to the lake.

Passage 2

Historians of commerce once portrayed early merchant courts as practical institutions that simply applied shared customs. Recent work has complicated that portrait. Court records show merchants invoking custom, but they also reveal disputes over what the custom required and strategic efforts to present novel practices as ancient usage. Written judgments, moreover, often appeared only after litigants pressed for them, so the surviving archive may overrepresent conflicts in which rules were already unsettled. The courts were therefore neither informal markets for compromise nor modern bureaucracies enforcing a fixed code. They were arenas in which commercial norms were asserted, contested, and gradually stabilized.

rc-004. Which of the following best describes the passage's central claim about early merchant courts?

- A. They enforced a stable body of custom without allowing litigants to challenge its meaning.
- B. They were chiefly informal institutions whose records tell historians little about commercial norms.
- C. They helped shape commercial norms through disputes over customs that were not always settled in advance.
- D. They became modern bureaucracies once merchants began requesting written judgments.
- E. They encouraged merchants to abandon custom in favor of entirely novel practices.

rc-005. The passage implies that historians using written judgments from merchant courts should be cautious because those judgments may

- A. come disproportionately from cases in which the relevant customs were disputed.
- B. record only cases in which merchants had already abandoned commercial custom.
- C. prove that litigants never used strategic arguments about tradition.
- D. show that merchant courts avoided all attempts to stabilize commercial rules.
- E. be less informative than records from modern bureaucratic courts in every respect.

rc-006. Select the sentence that most directly identifies a possible bias in the surviving evidence.

- A. Historians of commerce once portrayed early merchant courts as practical institutions that simply applied shared customs.
- B. Recent work has complicated that portrait.
- C. Court records show merchants invoking custom, but they also reveal disputes over what the custom required and strategic efforts to present novel practices as ancient usage.
- D. Written judgments, moreover, often appeared only after litigants pressed for them, so the surviving archive may overrepresent conflicts in which rules were already unsettled.
- E. The courts were therefore neither informal markets for compromise nor modern bureaucracies enforcing a fixed code.
- F. They were arenas in which commercial norms were asserted, contested, and gradually stabilized.

Passage 3

Single-cell RNA sequencing has encouraged biologists to classify tissue samples into ever finer cell types. Yet a cluster in such data is not automatically a biological kind. Cells captured at different moments in a continuous process can appear as separate groups, while stressed

cells may cluster together because the preparation procedure altered their transcription. Conversely, a real functional difference may disappear if the genes that mark it are expressed only briefly. For this reason, many researchers pair clustering algorithms with lineage tracing, protein assays, and experiments that perturb candidate pathways. The aim is not to abandon computational classification, but to prevent the convenience of discrete categories from being mistaken for proof that nature is organized discretely.

rc-007. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. arguing that single-cell RNA sequencing should be replaced by protein assays.
- B. explaining why computational clusters require biological validation before being treated as cell types.
- C. showing that preparation procedures always prevent accurate tissue classification.
- D. describing how lineage tracing has made clustering algorithms obsolete.
- E. criticizing biologists for ignoring continuous processes in all tissue samples.

rc-008. The reference to stressed cells primarily serves to

- A. give an example of how an apparent cluster may result from the experimental process rather than from a stable biological type.
- B. show that stressed cells are the most important cell type in tissue samples.
- C. identify the main reason protein assays are less reliable than sequencing.
- D. argue that transcriptional data cannot reveal any biological differences.
- E. explain why real functional differences are always temporary.

rc-009. Which of the following considerations support the passage's caution about treating clusters as biological kinds? Select all that apply.

- A. Cells in different phases of one continuous process may appear as separate groups.
- B. Preparation procedures may alter cells in ways that affect clustering.
- C. Every computational cluster corresponds to a stable and discrete functional type.

Passage 4

Dance historians trying to reconstruct early stage works often rely on notation systems that record steps, facings, and floor patterns. Such documents are indispensable, but they preserve only part of a performance. They rarely specify the weight of a gesture, the timing of a hesitation, or the rapport between performers that made a sequence intelligible to audiences. Films and reviews can fill some gaps, though each introduces its own distortions: cameras choose angles, and reviewers may emphasize novelty over routine. A reconstruction is strongest, then, when it presents movement scores, visual records, and contemporary commentary as mutually limiting evidence. Fidelity in this field is less a matter of reproducing every recorded step than of explaining why one plausible performance has been chosen over others.

rc-010. Which of the following best captures the passage's main point?

- A. Dance notation systems are too incomplete to be useful in reconstructing early stage works.
- B. Reliable dance reconstruction requires combining incomplete sources and acknowledging interpretive choices.
- C. Films are usually more faithful records of performance than notation systems or reviews.
- D. Historians should reconstruct only those performances whose original audiences described them in detail.
- E. The goal of reconstruction is to reproduce every recorded step as literally as possible.

rc-011. The passage suggests that a reconstruction based only on notation would be vulnerable because notation generally

- A. records only audience reactions and omits the sequence of movements.
- B. preserves some formal features of movement while leaving out expressive and relational aspects of performance.
- C. distorts a performance by choosing camera angles.
- D. overemphasizes novelty because it is written after the performance.
- E. prevents historians from identifying any plausible version of a work.

rc-012. Select the sentence that most directly states the passage's standard for a strong reconstruction.

- A. Dance historians trying to reconstruct early stage works often rely on notation systems that record steps, facings, and floor patterns.
- B. Such documents are indispensable, but they preserve only part of a performance.
- C. They rarely specify the weight of a gesture, the timing of a hesitation, or the rapport between performers that made a sequence intelligible to audiences.
- D. Films and reviews can fill some gaps, though each introduces its own distortions: cameras choose angles, and reviewers may emphasize novelty over routine.
- E. A reconstruction is strongest, then, when it presents movement scores, visual records, and contemporary commentary as mutually limiting evidence.
- F. Fidelity in this field is less a matter of reproducing every recorded step than of explaining why one plausible performance has been chosen over others.

Passage 5

Companies often treat average customer ratings as direct measures of service quality, but the averages can conceal different problems. A hotel whose guests mostly give moderate scores may need broad operational improvement; one with many excellent ratings and a small number of very low ratings may have a few recurring failures that are hidden by the mean. The timing of requests for feedback also matters: surveys sent immediately after checkout tend to capture memorable inconveniences, whereas surveys sent weeks later may reflect a more general impression. Analysts who study these data therefore recommend examining distributions, comments, and sampling procedures before drawing managerial conclusions. A rating is informative, but only after one asks what experiences were likely to produce it.

rc-013. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. arguing that customer ratings should be ignored because guests rarely report service problems accurately.
- B. explaining why average ratings require contextual analysis before being used to evaluate service quality.
- C. showing that hotels with many excellent ratings usually have worse service than hotels with moderate ratings.
- D. recommending that companies delay all feedback requests until weeks after a service encounter.
- E. claiming that written comments are objective measures while numerical ratings are subjective ones.

rc-014. According to the passage, two hotels with the same average rating might require different managerial responses because

- A. one average may reflect many similar experiences, while another may mask a pattern of

extreme negative experiences.

B. all ratings collected immediately after checkout are less accurate than ratings collected weeks later.

C. guests who give excellent ratings never mention recurring service failures.

D. a hotel's average rating is determined only by the number of comments submitted.

E. sampling procedures matter less than whether a company publishes its ratings.

rc-015. Which of the following would the analysts mentioned in the passage likely recommend examining before drawing conclusions from average ratings? Select all that apply.

A. The distribution of individual ratings.

B. Written comments accompanying the ratings.

C. The procedure used to sample or solicit responses.

Text Completion

tc-001. The grant proposal was ostensibly interdisciplinary, but its treatment of neighboring fields was so [blank_1] that specialists complained their work had been reduced to decorative citations.

Blank 1

A. perfunctory

B. integrative

C. exhaustive

D. prophetic

E. conciliatory

tc-002. Because the city publishes raw budget data without definitions, the dashboard can appear [blank_1]: it looks transparent while leaving nonspecialists unsure what the categories mean.

Blank 1

A. opaque

B. frugal

C. redundant

D. meticulous

E. permissive

tc-003. The critic's objection was not that the novel was too experimental, but that its experiments were [blank_1], serving no discernible purpose in the plot.

Blank 1

A. innovative

B. gratuitous

C. restrained

D. inevitable

E. lucid

tc-004. The mayor praised the pilot program as (i) [blank_1], but the report's missing control group made its apparent success (ii) [blank_2].

Blank 1

A. promising

- B. obsolete
- C. inconspicuous

Blank 2

- D. difficult to interpret
- E. above reproach
- F. irrelevant

tc-005. Because the poet's revisions removed every local reference, readers found the final version less (i) [blank_1] than the draft, though its general themes became more (ii) [blank_2].

Blank 1

- A. particularized
- B. evasive
- C. doctrinaire

Blank 2

- D. universal
- E. cryptic
- F. provincial

tc-006. The consultant claimed to (i) [blank_1] the museum's mission, yet her plan narrowed exhibits to blockbuster shows, a proposal trustees saw as (ii) [blank_2] rather than expansive.

Blank 1

- A. broaden
- B. codify
- C. archive

Blank 2

- D. constrictive
- E. balanced
- F. philanthropic

tc-007. The committee's minutes have been cited as (i) [blank_1] evidence that members opposed the merger, but the document is more (ii) [blank_2]: it records hesitation about the timetable, not rejection of the deal. To treat it as decisive is therefore to (iii) [blank_3] a procedural worry into a substantive veto.

Blank 1

- A. unequivocal
- B. incidental
- C. fabricated

Blank 2

- D. equivocal
- E. redundant
- F. unanimous

Blank 3

- G. inflate
- H. translate
- I. dissolve

tc-008. The philosopher's reputation for (i) [blank_1] is puzzling, since her published work

repeatedly (ii) [blank_2] final answers and instead traces how each proposed solution generates new questions. Her method is rigorous, but hardly (iii) [blank_3].

Blank 1

- A. dogmatism
- B. levity
- C. erudition

Blank 2

- D. resists
- E. supplies
- F. obscures

Blank 3

- G. doctrinaire
- H. systematic
- I. digressive

tc-009. The archive seemed at first to (i) [blank_1] the official account, since several letters repeated its central claim; closer inspection, however, showed that those letters all derived from a single circular, making the apparent corroboration (ii) [blank_2] and the account's evidentiary basis (iii) [blank_3].

Blank 1

- A. corroborate
- B. complicate
- C. ignore

Blank 2

- D. illusory
- E. independent
- F. cumulative

Blank 3

- G. fragile
- H. abundant
- I. irrelevant

Sentence Equivalence

se-001. The panelist's reply was [blank_1], answering the procedural objection without addressing the ethical challenge that had prompted it.

- A. forthright
- B. evasive
- C. exhaustive
- D. oblique
- E. conciliatory
- F. explicit

se-002. Because the new taxonomy renamed familiar categories without changing the criteria for membership, many researchers regarded it as [blank_1].

- A. rigorous
- B. cosmetic
- C. provisional

- D. superficial
- E. exhaustive
- F. contentious

se-003. The article's tone is [blank_1], granting the opposing study several strengths before identifying the assumption that limits its conclusion.

- A. dismissive
- B. measured
- C. balanced
- D. caustic
- E. indifferent
- F. hostile

se-004. The foundation's annual report was [blank_1]: it announced rising donations but omitted the one-time bequest that made the increase possible.

- A. comprehensive
- B. misleading
- C. laconic
- D. deceptive
- E. celebratory
- F. meticulous

se-005. The professor was not [blank_1] about the theory; even in lectures defending it, she cataloged the evidence that might overturn it.

- A. skeptical
- B. doctrinaire
- C. dogmatic
- D. cautious
- E. indifferent
- F. tentative

se-006. The committee's final report was [blank_1], stitching together incompatible recommendations in order to avoid alienating any faction.

- A. conciliatory
- B. incoherent
- C. decisive
- D. inconsistent
- E. unanimous
- F. meticulous